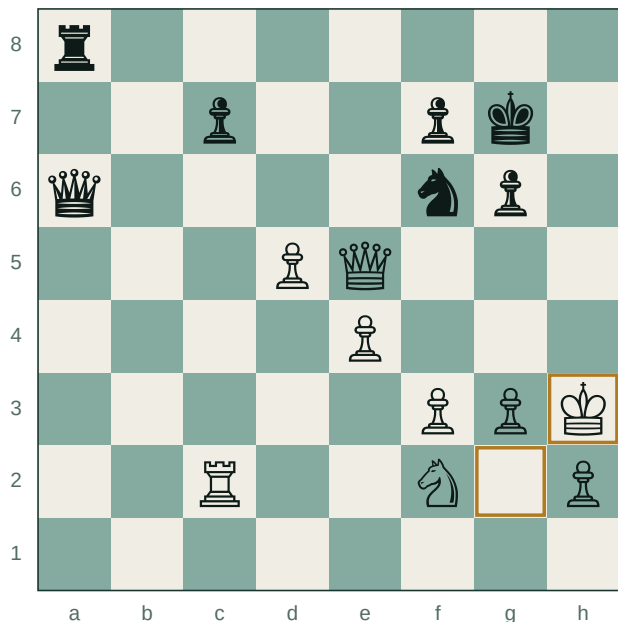


Skewers: Black, move 34

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Kxh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Qf1+ 35. Kh4 Rh8+ 36. Kg5 Rh5+ 37. Kf4 Rxe5

34...Qf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f1 it attacks king on h3 and knight on f2. Recorded reply: **35.Kh4**.

35...Rh8+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36.Kg5**.

36...Rh5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kf4**.

37...Rxe5 The rook captures the queen on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -2 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on h3. Geometrically undefended: queen on e5 and rook on c2. Check for tactical protection.